MODULE 1

Most healthcare managers were promoted because they were excellent clinicians or operators.

Almost none of them were taught how to actually lead the people around them.

Not everyone on your team is motivated by the same thing — and managing as if they are is costing you.

- Autonomy, mastery, and purpose drive most high performers — not recognition alone.
- The team member who looks disengaged may just be in the wrong type of role, not the wrong organization.
- One management style applied to five different people produces three disengaged employees.

KEY INSIGHT
Motivation is individual. Your job is to find what drives each person — not assume they all want the same thing.

The most common communication failure isn't saying the wrong thing. It's saying the right thing in the wrong order.

- Building to your point trains your audience to disengage before you get there.
- The Pyramid Principle: lead with your recommendation, follow with support.
- Structure is not style — it's respect for the other person's time and attention.

KEY INSIGHT
If your audience has to wait for your point, you've already lost half of them.

The conflict you're managing around hasn't gone away. It has gone underground — and it's growing.

- Unaddressed conflict doesn't resolve. It calcifies into resentment and quiet disengagement.
- Most managers avoid conflict because they confuse discomfort with damage.
- Productive conflict is not aggression — it's honesty delivered with care.

KEY INSIGHT
The conversation you're dreading usually takes less than 10 minutes. The cost of not having it takes months.

Refusing to engage in organizational politics doesn't make you principled. It makes you powerless.

- Politics is not manipulation — it's understanding how decisions actually get made in your organization.
- Ideas without advocates die in meetings. Build the relationships before you need them.
- The manager who understands the informal power structure can move faster and with less friction.

KEY INSIGHT
Your best idea needs allies. Who are the people who need to be in your corner before the meeting starts?

5 DELEGATION

If you're doing work your team should be doing, you're not protecting quality. You're preventing growth.

- Every task you hold onto is a development opportunity you're withholding from your team.
- Under-delegation creates bottlenecks. Over-delegation creates failures. Both are management problems.
- The goal is not to hand off tasks — it's to transfer capability.

KEY INSIGHT
What on your plate today could be developing someone else tomorrow?

FRAMEWORK

The Motivation Spectrum

Motivation is not one-dimensional. Understanding where each team member sits on this spectrum is the prerequisite for leading them effectively.

1. Compliance: doing the minimum required. Often a management or clarity problem.
2. Engagement: invested in the work. Responds to recognition, feedback, and belonging.
3. Purpose: driven by the mission itself. Needs alignment between work and values.
4. Ownership: treats the outcome as their own. Needs trust, authority, and challenge.
5. Match your management approach to each level — not to your preference.

REFLECT ON THIS

Your team reflects the leadership they've received.

What would your team say if asked: does our manager lead us, or just manage our output?

TRY THIS

Three things to try this week:

1. Name one team member you've been managing the same way for 6+ months. What do they actually need?

2. Identify one conflict you've been managing around. Write the opening sentence you'd use to address it.

3. Pick one task on your plate that should belong to someone on your team. Give it to them this week.

The Focused Leader

Module 1 · Leadership & People Skills

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